



LAKEWOOD CITY COUNCIL MINUTES

Monday, August 18, 2025

City of Lakewood

6000 Main Street SW

Lakewood, WA 98499

<https://us02web.zoom.us/j/86872632373>

Dial +1(253) 215- 8782 Participant ID: 868 7263 2373

CALL TO ORDER

Mayor Whalen called the meeting to order at 7:00 p.m.

ROLL CALL

Councilmembers Present: 6 – Mayor Jason Whalen, Deputy Mayor Mary Moss, Councilmembers Michael Brandstetter, Ryan Pearson, Patti Belle, and Paul Bocchi.

Councilmembers Excused: 1 – Councilmember J. Trestin Lauricella.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE

Mayor Whalen paused for a moment of silence and led the Pledge of Allegiance.

PROCLAMATIONS AND PRESENTATIONS

Recognition of the Lakewood Police Department 2025 Citizens Academy Graduates.

Mayor Whalen and Captain Westby recognized Jonathan Arneson, James Arroyo, Xavier Barrios, Silvana Cantu, Ute Carr, Jesse LaMora, Jill Lindberg, Matthew Manibusan, Rob Middleton, Melanie Miller, David Rich, Sergio Rosales and Becki Torgerson with Certificates of Recognition for their participation in an 8-week academy learning about various Police Department functions.

PUBLIC COMMENTS

The City Council received written comments in advance of the meeting from Sharyce Martin.

Rick Wright, Lakewood United Pentecostal Church, expressed concerns about vandalism, graffiti and loud music and from local car clubs who are gathering around Colonial Plaza.

Sharyce Martin, Lakewood resident, expressed concerns about vandalism, graffiti and loud noise from local car clubs who are gathering around Colonial Plaza.

Sharon Parchia, Lakewood resident, expressed concerns about fireworks, yelling and vandalism from local car clubs who are gathering around Colonial Plaza.

Christina Manetti, Lakewood resident, expressed concerns about lack of public awareness around paving and impervious surfaces and in support of protections for Garry Oak trees.

Christina Manetti, Garry Oak Coalition, spoke about possible oak tree and Critical Areas Ordinance violations and lack of response from the City when inquiring about these projects and in support of a de-paving program.

Charles Ames, Lakewood resident, spoke about interactions with the caretaker of the Community Garden at Springbrook Park.

Haley Ivey, spoke about litter at Edgewater Park and in support of respecting the lake and keeping the environment intact.

Jerilee B Ellis, Springbrook community, spoke about interactions with the Community Garden Manager, food rotting and in support of a new garden manager being assigned.

C O N S E N T A G E N D A

- A. Approval of the minutes of the City Council meeting of August 4, 2025.

- B. Motion No. 2025-55

Authorizing the execution of an agreement with the Washington State Healthcare Authority for the Lakewood CHOICE Program.

- C. Motion No. 2025-56

Authorizing the execution the Washington State Allocation Agreement and other necessary agreements governing the allocation of funds paid by the Purdue Bankruptcy, Sacklers and certain opioid manufactures.

- D. Motion No. 2025-57

Authorizing the execution of an agreement with Clover Park School District for Extra Duty police services; School Resource Officers.

E. Motion No. 2025-58

Reappointing Ken Witkoe and appointing Sharyce Martin, Johnnie Mayfield, and Kristi Merritt to serve on the Public Safety Advisory Committee through August 6, 2028.

F. Motion No. 2025-59

Appointing Kyung (Kellis) Parlett to serve on the Lakewood Arts Commission through October 15, 2028.

G. Items filed in the Office of the City Clerk:

1. Arts Commission meeting minutes of June 9, 2025.
2. Community Services Advisory Board meeting minutes of June 18, 2025.

DEPUTY MAYOR MOSS MOVED TO ADOPT THE CONSENT AGENDA. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

R E G U L A R A G E N D A

ORDINANCE

Ordinance No. 833 Adopting amendments to Lakewood Municipal Code Titles 1, 2, 12, 14, 16, 17, 18A, 18B, and 18C related to the 2025 Development Regulations.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO ADOPT ORDINANCE NO. 833. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER.

COUNCILMEMBER PEARSON MOVED TO AMEND ORDINANCE NO. 833, TO EXPAND THE BAR/TAVERN ZONING CLASSIFICATION TO PERMITTED IN THE CBD, NC1, NC1 AND TOC. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER BELLE. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND FAILED WITH COUNCILMEMBERS BELLE, BOCCHI, BRANDSTETTER, PEARSON, DEPUTY MAYOR MOSS AND MAYOR WHALEN VOTING IN OPPOSITION.

COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER MOVED TO DELETE AMENDMENT NO. 6. SECONDED BY DEPUTY MAYOR MOSS. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN ON ORDINANCE NO. 833 AS AMENDED AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

Ordinance No. 834 Amending Lakewood Municipal Code Chapter 5.02.050 updating the Business License Model Threshold for out-of-city businesses.

COUNCILMEMBER BRANDSTETTER MOVED TO ADOPT ORDINANCE NO. 834. SECONDED BY COUNCILMEMBER BOCCHI. VOICE VOTE WAS TAKEN AND CARRIED UNANIMOUSLY.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None.

NEW BUSINESS

None.

ITEMS FOR DISCUSSION

Municipal Court Update.

Municipal Court Judge Tim Lewis shared that there has been a steady increase in infractions and criminal filings over the past year and he provided an overview of Probation Services and Therapeutic Court Programs. Discussion ensued.

At 7:56 p.m., Mayor Whalen announced that the City Council will recess for approximately 5 five minutes. The City Council reconvened at 8:00 p.m.

REPORTS BY THE CITY MANAGER

Interim City Manager Tho Kraus reported that Sister City Danzhou, China has requested to visit on September 23rd and the discussion should include tours and a discussion with the Tacoma Pierce County Economic Development Board and Port of Tacoma. Sister City Gimhae, South Korea delegates will visit the City on October 30th for one night for eight delegates and they have invited the City to the Gimhae Ceramic Festival in the beginning of November.

She then shared that the City Clerk has been monitoring neighborhood association and Desserts on the Driveway events and recommended that Councilmembers be assigned to attend each meeting. After discussion, the City Clerk will notice future meetings indicating that there may be a quorum.

She then announced the following upcoming meetings and events:

- August 19, 6:30 P.M. to 8:00 P.M., Summer Nights at the Pavilion Concerts, Fort Steilacoom Park
- August 19, 6:30 P.M., Tillicum Neighborhood Association, Tillicum Community Center
- August 20, 11:00 A.M., Pierce Transit World Cup Summit, Tacoma Dome Station
- August 20, 5:00 P.M. to 6:30 P.M., Historic Fort Steilacoom Sign Dedication Event, Historic Fort Steilacoom
- August 21, 8 A.M. to 10 A.M., Clover Park School District 2025-2026 School Kickoff Event, Harry Lang Stadium
- August 21, 6:00 P.M., Desserts in the Driveway, Clover Creek Neighborhood, Tyee Elementary School
- August 22, 12:00 P.M., NBrothers Bakery Grand Opening Event, 6020 Main Street SW Suite K
- August 23, 12:00 P.M. to 3:00 P.M., Youth Council Kick Off Event, Fort Steilacoom Park Pavilion
- August 27, 10:00 A.M. to 12:00 P.M., Housing Roundtable with Lieutenant Governor Denny Heck, Virtual
- August 28, 12:30 P.M., LASA Gravelly Lake Commons Groundbreaking
- August 28, 6:00 P.M., Desserts in the Driveway, Fort Steilacoom Park Pavilion
- August 29, 3:00 P.M. to 7:30 P.M., Asia Pacific Cultural Center Grand Opening of New Building
- September 1, 11:00 A.M. to 4:00 P.M., Buffalo Soldiers Labor Day Festival, Cheney Stadium
- September 6, 12:00 P.M. to 6:00 P.M., Fiesta De La Familia, Fort Steilacoom Park
- September 6, 11 A.M., Tacoma Garden Club 100th anniversary Flower Show St. John's Lutheran Church 8602 Bridgeport Way

She then shared that City Manager Doug Russell will begin on August 26th and she thanked the City Council for the opportunity to serve as Interim City Manager.

CITY COUNCIL COMMENTS

Councilmember Bocchi shared that Pierce County Regional Council meeting has been cancelled and he complimented work done on the Steilacoom Boulevard project.

Councilmember Pearson shared that last week he participated in a Ride Along and he will attend the Youth Council Kick Off event. He then thanked Tho Kraus for serving the Interim City Manager.

Councilmember Brandstetter thanked Tho Kraus for serving as Interim City Manager, he spoke about the October 2nd PSRC Regional Transportation Planning in Pierce County, he requested that the City send a letter of condolences to the Spokane County Sheriff's Office and this week he will attend the South Sound 911 Board meeting.

Councilmember Belle requested follow up on the public comments regarding Colonial Plaza, she thanked those who participated in the Lakewood Police Citizens Academy and shared that she participated in Desserts in the Driveway and this week she will attend the Summer Concerts and the Youth Council Kick off event. She also complimented Tho Kraus for her work as Interim City Manager.

Deputy Mayor Moss thanked Tho Kraus for serving as Interim City Manager and shared that she attended Desserts on the Driveway and requested follow up on the public comments regarding the Springbrook Community Gardens. She shared that she will attend the Back to School event this week.

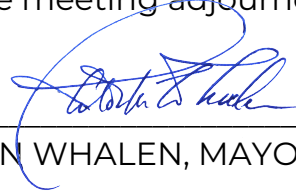
Mayor Whalen thanked Tho Kraus for her service as Interim City Manager. He shared that he attended a Back-to-School event in Tillicum, Dessert on the Driveway and the Lake City Neighborhood Association Meeting. He then spoke about the various events he will attend this week and requested follow up on the public comments regarding Colonial Plaza.

Mayor Whalen announced that the City Council will recess into Executive Session for approximately 15 minutes pursuant to RCW 42.30.110(1)(i) to discuss with legal counsel representing the agency litigation or potential litigation to which the agency, the governing body, or a member acting in an official capacity is, or is likely to become a party, when public knowledge regarding the discussion is likely to result in an adverse legal or financial consequence to the agency. The City Council is not expected

to take action other than to adjourn the meeting. The City Council recessed at 8:50 p.m. and reconvened at 9:03 p.m.

ADJOURNMENT

There being no further business, the meeting adjourned at 9:03 p.m.



JASON WHALEN, MAYOR

ATTEST:



BRIANA SCHUMACHER
CITY CLERK